

Kalpana Robotics

Placement linked robotics and embedded training for tier 2 engineering colleges

Seed round, July 2026

Kozhikode, Kerala

The problem

- A tier 2 engineering college in Kerala places maybe a third of its electronics batch.
- The syllabus was written before the jobs existed.
- Employers in Coimbatore and Hosur cannot fill embedded roles and hire from Bengaluru instead.
- Both sides of the market are unhappy and they are ninety minutes apart.

What we do

- We run a two semester robotics and embedded lab inside the college, on our kit.
- The curriculum is written from live job descriptions, not from a textbook.
- We bring the employers to the campus and run the hiring rounds ourselves.
- 71 percent of students on the placement track are placed within six months.

Who pays and why

- The college pays, not the student. Rs 4,860 per student per term.
- A college sells its placement rate to next year's admissions, so this is a growth cost.
- That makes it a budget line, not a discretionary purchase, which is why renewal is 88 percent.
- Students pay nothing, which is the only way this works in a Kerala government college.

Traction

- ARR of Rs 2.06 crore in July 2026, from Rs 18 lakh two years ago.
- 34 colleges under contract across Kerala and Tamil Nadu.
- 4,820 students trained, 2,487 placed.
- 46 employer partners actively hiring from the programme.

The number that sells it

- Median first salary on the programme is Rs 4.6 lakh.
- The campus baseline in the same colleges is Rs 2.8 lakh.
- That gap is what a principal repeats to parents at the admission counter.
- We track it per college and publish it back to them every term.

Unit economics

- Rs 4,860 revenue per student per term, Rs 1,680 gross contribution.
- One trainer covers 40 students, which is the main lever on margin.
- Lab kits are ours, amortised over three years, and move between colleges.
- A 34 college base is contribution positive today at 64 percent trainer utilisation.

Why this scales in tier 2

- Kerala and Tamil Nadu together hold over 700 engineering colleges.
- Employers in Coimbatore, Hosur and Kochi are hiring embedded talent continuously.
- One trainer can cover three colleges inside a 60 km radius with no overnight stay.
- The same density exists in coastal Andhra and western Maharashtra.

Use of funds

- Rs 5.0 crore, expected to last 15 months.
- Rs 1.8 crore: trainer hiring and a residential trainer academy.
- Rs 1.4 crore: lab kits for 40 more colleges.
- Rs 1.2 crore: employer side team, because placements are the product.
- Rs 0.6 crore: reserve.

The team

- Sreelakshmi Menon, CEO. Ran campus hiring for an automotive electronics supplier.
- Vishnu Prasad, Curriculum. Embedded engineer, wrote the lab now running in 34 colleges.
- Jerin Sebastian, Employers. Six years staffing electronics manufacturing.
- 38 full time, of whom 26 are trainers.